



International Women's Day Celebrations

Kenya Partners Exhibition
and Trade Fair

CONCEPT NOTE





INTRODUCTION

Turning Point Magazine Africa is calling for partners to support Organize International Women's Day Celebration 2025. The proposed event will be a Two-Day Trade Fair to be hosted at the Kenyatta International Convention Centre (KICC) Courtyard, Nairobi, Kenya on 7th - 8th March, 2025, in celebration of The International Women's Day 2025. The event aims to bring together over 100 Exhibitors from government agencies, non-governmental organizations (NGOs), and corporate companies across Kenya and the Pan-African region with a targeting more than 20,000 footprints accessing KICC.

The 2025 theme, "Accelerate Action," builds on past years' focus on inclusion and progress, challenging stakeholders to speed up initiatives addressing systemic gender inequalities. The proposed Trade Fair is angled to serve as a platform to highlight initiatives that empower women, promote gender equality, and showcase collaborative projects fostering sustainable development.

The Trade Fair will culminate in the Launching of the Second Issue of the Turning Point Magazine. This will draw inspiration from the Magazine concept of amplifying grassroots voices and leveraging storytelling and highlighting transformative solutions towards gender equality in driving collective action for Kenya's women's empowerment and regional progress.

It will also be an opportunity to activate, and Launch Products, Programs and Projects by Exhibitors and celebrate 25 influential women in Africa as we Accelerate Action showcasing the gains so far in achieving Gender Equality.

The Trade Fair is directly aligned to Kenya's Gender Agenda, African Union's Agenda 2063 aspirations, emphasizing the role of women in achieving a prosperous and inclusive Africa and the overarching Agenda 2030 for development.

Theme

“For ALL women and girls: Rights.
Equality. Empowerment.”

Accelerate Action: Speeding up Women's Equality
for an Inclusive and Sustainable Future

LEAD PARTNER ORGANIZATION

1. Turning Point Magazine Africa

Turning Point Magazine is a dynamic quarterly publication launched in November 2023 by a team of professional volunteers with diverse expertise spanning IT, social work, sexual and reproductive health and rights (SRHR), environmentalism, health, education, agriculture, and business. This group came together with a shared vision: to amplify the voices of grassroots communities and shine a spotlight on impactful stories of change in a global ecosystem where such narratives often remain unheard.

Through a commitment to pro bono services, these professionals created a digital-first platform that bridges critical gaps in storytelling, collaboration, and actionable solutions. The magazine leverages offline and online campaigns to foster intergenerational dialogue, promote life-based programs, and inspire innovation in addressing pressing challenges. Originating in Kenya, Turning Point Magazine not only celebrates the country's rich cultural heritage, including collaborations with the vibrant Matatu industry, but also aims to target the broader African regional bloc and make waves on the global stage.

The platform positions itself as a resource for cross-sectoral partnerships, offering insights, success stories, and strategies that resonate with stakeholders across the NGO, corporate, donor, and government sectors. To deepen its impact, the magazine plans to engage various industries—including the beverage sector—to champion responsible health practices, sustainable development, and inclusive progress. By harnessing the power of storytelling and collaboration, Turning Point Magazine is committed to fostering meaningful dialogue and advancing solutions that address today's complex challenges.

Contextualization and State of Women Engagement in Africa

With its rich history of women's strong voices from way back on March 8, 1908 in New York City, Lower East Side, fast forward to March 8, 1910 when the Day was officially observed as the International Women's Day (IWD), every year, the celebrations have been used to recognize and accelerate social, economic, cultural, and political achievements of women. The bigger outlook has been to accelerate gender parity.

In one of its publications, the World Economic Forum estimates that it will take about five generations to realize gender parity in 2158, approximately 134 years. This estimate is bleak and the very reason why immediate and pragmatic action should be taken to #AccelerateAction. SDG 5 speaks to the urgent need to achieve gender equality and empower all women and girls. Women and girls engagement in the realization of the SDGs is double pronged as an objective and also as a solution. Therefore, their participation is necessary and inevitable. In the Article, "Promoting Gender Equality in Africa." by The International Finance Corporation (IFC), African women still lack access to many rights, opportunities, markets and assets enjoyed by men. Additionally, in Sub-Saharan Africa, the gender gap stands at 32% across four key areas: Political Participation, Economic Opportunity, Education, and Health.



There is the shocking revelation that it may take 95 years for Africa to achieve gender parity. IFC continues to state that there is a ray of hope as Africa leads the world regarding female representation in corporate boards at 25% compared to 17% globally. This means that corporate companies in Kenya as much as across Africa are doing so much towards women and girls economic empowerment and there is room for more collaborations and partnerships.

The Proposed Trade Fair will therefore focus on three broad Objectives, with a key highlight on the Launch of the Second Issue of Turning Point Magazine. These will enable the two days' event to allow a more collaborative approach in peer learning and sharing of best practice.

Main objectives

1. **To Accelerate Gender Equality:** Drive actionable steps to address gender disparities across economic, political, and social spheres in Africa, with a focus on Kenya.
2. **To Showcase and Promote Women's Leadership:** Showcase impactful initiatives and projects led by Kenyan and Pan-African women in governance, business, and community development as well as those in Civil Service.
3. **To Foster and Strengthen Regional Collaboration:** Facilitate partnerships among public, private, and civil society organizations for gender-inclusive policies and programs.
4. **To Launch the Second Issue of Turning Point Magazine Africa**



Implementation Framework

Day 1: Advocacy and Leadership

- Opening Ceremony: Remarks by Kenyan government leaders, UN representatives, Dignitaries, and Women's rights activists.
- Panel Discussions:
 - *Theme 1: Fast-Tracking Women Leadership and Innovative Approaches to Gender Equality in Kenya and Beyond.*
 - *Theme 2: Economic Empowerment Through Gender-Inclusive Investments.*
- Exhibition Launch: Stalls by exhibitors showcasing solutions for accelerating gender equality.
- Cultural Performances: Celebrating Africa's diversity and the resilience of its women.

Day 2: Empowerment, Innovation and Action

- Workshops: Skills building on digital entrepreneurship, advocacy strategies, Innovation and navigating systemic barriers for women.
- Networking Forums: Facilitating connections among exhibitors, partners, and participants.
- Closing Gala: Presentation of awards for outstanding exhibitors and adoption of Call to Action for gender equality #AccelerateAction.

Cross-Cutting Activities:

- Mainstream and Digital Media Campaigns: Amplifying (Live Streams) event highlights on Main Media and Social Media such as YouTube, Instagram, and TikTok.
- Resource Hub and Showcase: Distribution of informational resources and services (Legal Aid, Health Screening, Counseling, Blood Drive, Donations, Arts..) Spotlighting community-based projects driving change for women at the local level.

Turning Point Spotlight: A section in the exhibition showcasing grassroots transformation stories, as inspired by the Turning Point concept, with a focus on replicable community-driven solutions.

EXPECTED OUTCOMES

1. Strengthened cross-sector partnerships for gender equality and women's empowerment in Kenya and across Africa.
2. Increased visibility and support for grassroots women-led initiatives.
3. Practical skills and resources provided to over 1,000 participants, fostering sustainable community impact.
4. Adoption of measurable commitments for accelerating women's equality in alignment with Agenda 2063, broadening regional dialogue on innovative solutions.
5. Amplified grassroots voices through storytelling and collaboration, inspired by the **Turning Point Magazine Concept**.
6. Adoption of a Call to Action on **#AccelerateAction**

We intentionally emphasize and align with global and Pan-African themes so that the International Women's Day Trade Fair 2025 catalyzes progress, creating lasting social and economic change, making women pivotal agents of sustainable development.



IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

Activity / Task	Timeframe	Responsible
Final Event Concept	January 2025	Steering Committee
Partners & Exhibitor Signage	January / February	Marketing Team
Speakers & Guests	January - 4th March	Steering Committee
Venue Logistics	January / Feb / 3 -5 March	Logistics Team
Resource Mobilization	January - March 2025	Communication & Marketing
Gala Dinner / Awards	February - March 2025	Awards Team
D-Days	7 - 8 March 2025	All Teams
Feedback Collection	9 - 20 March 2025	M & E Team
Report and Dissemination	March 2025	M&E and Comms Teams

MONITORING AND EVALUATION FRAMEWORK

Indicator	Target	Data Source	Frequency
No. of Exhibitors	100+	Registration Records	Pre-Event
Total Footprints	5,000+	Registration, Ticket Sales	During Event
Partnerships Negotiated	30+	Post Event Surveys	Post Event
Social Media Reach	200,000+	Analytics	During / Post Event
Participants Satisfaction	70% - 90% +Feedback	Post event Survey	Post Event
Media Coverage	15+	Media Tracking	Post Event
Grassroot / Women Leaders Stories	30+	Records/ Follow Ups	During Event
Sponsors & Partners Satisfaction	80% - 95%	Post Event Surveys	During / Post event



BUDGET ESTIMATES

Category / Item	Estimate Cost (KES)
Venue	800,000
Marketing and Communication	350,000
Exhibition Stalls	700,000
Social Media Activation (Live Streaming, Sound, Lighting, Translation)	600,000
Event Materials (Banners, Kits..)	350,000
Cultural Performances	300,000
Gala Dinner (200 Pax)	1,200,000
Certificates and Trophies	250,000
Keynote Speakers and Facilitators	450,000
Air Transfers Tickets	350,000
Administration	265,000
Miscellaneous	250,000
TOTAL	5,865,000

Venue

Kenyatta International Convention Centre (KICC)

Date

March 7th-8th,2025
From 8:00am - 4:00pm

Participants

High-level representatives from the Permanent Secretaries' Office, UN agencies, local embassies, private sector leaders, NGO executive directors, and key media personalities.

Language

Forum communications will put into consideration needs for language translation and disability accessibility needs.

Thank you for Partnering with Us

Turning Point Magazine

Transforming Everyday

Turning Point Magazine Africa

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